INDIAN INSTITUTE OF MANAGEMENT KOZHIKODE

Course Outline

Programme Name	Bachelor of Management Studies (BMS)
Course Code & Course Title	Organisational Behaviour
Course type	Core
Pre-requisites (if any)	NIL
Course Credit	4
Total no. of sessions	30
Session Duration	02 Hrs
Term	03
Year and Batch	2026, BMS 01
Sections (if any)	A & B
Instructor	Dr. Vijay Kuriakose
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Office	
Consultation Hours	Prior Appointment

Introduction

Organisational Behaviour (OB) is the systematic study of individual, group, and organisational processes that influence behaviour in the workplace. It integrates concepts from psychology, sociology, anthropology, and management to explain why people behave the way they do within organisations and how such behaviour affects organisational effectiveness. In an era characterised by rapid technological advancements, globalisation, hybrid work arrangements, workforce diversity, and artificial intelligence, understanding human behaviour has become a critical managerial competency.

This course introduces students to the fundamental principles of organisational behaviour by examining how individual differences, personality, perception, motivation, emotions, attitudes, leadership, power, conflict, organisational culture, and change shape workplace outcomes. The course emphasises the application of behavioural theories to contemporary organisational challenges and equips students with practical skills to analyse, interpret, and manage workplace behaviour effectively.

Designed for undergraduate management students, the course adopts an application-oriented approach that combines theoretical foundations with case studies, self-assessments, and experiential learning activities. Students will develop critical thinking, interpersonal competence, ethical decision-making, and collaborative problem-solving skills that are essential for effective leadership and professional success across diverse organisational contexts. By the end of the course, students will possess a strong understanding of how behavioural principles can be leveraged to enhance employee well-being, organisational performance, and sustainable business practices.

Learning Objective / Course Outcome

CLO	Course Learning Outcome	Key Verb	Linked PLO No	Key word linking CLO with PLO	Degree of emphasis given to the PLO in the course	Measured
CLO1	Explain key concepts, theories, and frameworks of organisational behaviour related to individual, group, and organisational processes.	Explain	PLO 1.1	Knowledge,Concepts, and Theories	Introduced	Not Measured
CLO2	Analyse the influence of behavioural and organisational factors on workplace relationships, employee well-being, decision-making, and organisational effectiveness.	Analyse	PLO 2.1	Organisational Effectiveness	Introduced	Not Measured
CLO3	Apply organisational behaviour theories and frameworks to critically evaluate real-world organisational challenges and develop ethical, evidence-based, and contextually appropriate solutions.	Apply	PLO 1.3	Ethical Decision-Making	Emphasized	Not Measured

Textbooks and Learning Materials (if any)

Text Book	Organizational Behaviour:A Practical Problem Solving Approach , Angelo Kinicki, Damini Saini Publisher McGraw Hill
Reference Book	Organizational Behaviour: Emerging Knowledge: By Steven L McShane, Mary Ann Von Glinow, Himanshu Rai Publisher McGraw Hill

Readings (if any)

R1	An unlikely top US workplace: The Indiana Department of Revenue's cultural transformation By: Douglas R. Austrom
R2	Getting to the Bottom of Destructive Behaviours By: Ron Carucci
R3	Our Favourite Management Tips on Motivating Your Team By: HBR Editors
R4	Storytelling That Drives Bold Change By: Frances X. Frei, Anne Morriss
R5	Is Your Leadership Style Too Nice? By: Ron Ashkenas, Gali Cooks
R6	Essential Leadership Skills - and How to Develop Them By: Rebecca Knight
R7	Don't Let Outdated Management Structures Kill Your Company By: Vineet Nayar
R8	People Follow Structure: How Less Hierarchy Changes the Workforce By: Markus Reitzig, Kathrin Heiss

Technology & Software (if any)

	NA

Other Resources (Journals, Internet Websites) (if any)

1	Journal of Organisational Behaviour
2	Journal of Applied Psychology
3	Journal of Occupational Health Psychology

Case Studies

Case 1	Mass Rapid Transit: Going Off Track By: Vivien K.G. Lim, Nikodemus Jaya
Case 2	DRW Technologies By: Stephen A. Greyser
Case 3	AVL Limited: Power and Politics By: Dina Banerjee, Richa Jain
Case 4	Conflict Management at TKC Consulting By: V Padhmanabhan
Case 5	Orix Geoscience: Scaling Up Employee Engagement (Motivation) By: Martha L.Maznevski, Ramasastry Chandrasekhar
Case 6	Southwest Airlines' Nonstop Culture: Flying High with Transparency and Empowerment By: Wayne Baker
Case 7	Prudence in a maze of metaphors (individual differences) By: Vanina Farber, Heather Cairns-Lee
Case 8	Managing Diversity and Inclusion at Yelp (Social Perception and managing diversity) By: Michael Luca, Joshua R. Schwartzstein, Gauri Subramani

Pedagogy/Learning Process

The course integrates lectures that introduce each theme with interactive classroom discussions grounded in the course readings. Learning is further supported through in-class activities, short exercises, and the selective use of visual resources. Both the course content and assessment components are designed to promote inquiry-based, discussion-oriented, and activity-based learning. Students are expected to complete the assigned readings for each session and arrive prepared to actively participate in class discussions and activities.

Evaluation Components/Assessment of Student Learning

Assessment Tool	Weight	Remarks
Quizzes	10 %	Quiz will assess the conceptual understanding
Attendance	10 %	Attendance will assess students' regularity and punctuality in attending classes and their commitment to consistent classroom engagement.
Project	20 %	Project will examine the ability of the students to apply the concepts discussed in the course in real life settings
Mid term	30 %	Examinations will evaluate students' comprehensive understanding of the course material by assessing their knowledge of the prescribed readings and their ability to integrate, analyze, and apply this knowledge when responding to open-ended questions.
End term	30 %	

Session Plan

Session No.	Module	TopicS covered	Reading Material
Module 1: Introduction to Organisational Behaviour			
1&2	1	**Introduction: How OB works** Workplace effectiveness and organisational performance.	Chapter 1 **R1**
3&4	1	**Ethics and Problem Solving** Explores the relationship between ethics and performance while developing structured problem-solving skills.	Chapter 1 (1.2,1.3,1.4) **R2**
5	1	**Interaction with Industry Expert**	
Module 2: Values and Attitudes			
6	2	**Personal Values** Personal attitudes and their impact on organisational performance.	Chapter 2 (2.1,2.2,2.3)
7	2	**Job Satisfaction** Job satisfaction is a reality or a workplace myth.	Chapter 2 (2.4,2.5,2.6)
Module 3: Emotions and Social Perception			
8	3	**Emotional Dynamics in Organisations** Does emotions effect your Organisational Effectiveness	Chapter 3 (3.5,3.6) **R3** **Case 7**
9&10	3	**Social Perception and Interpersonal Relations**	Chapter4 (4.1,4.2,4.3) **Case 8**

		How individuals perceive and interpret others, with emphasis on attribution, stereotypes, and biases in workplace interactions.	
Module 4: Foundations of Employee Motivation			
11& 12	4	**Theories and Applications of Workplace Motivation** Do Motivation Theories Accurately Explain Motivation in Real-World Organisational Settings.	Chapter 5 (5.1,5.2,5.3,5.4) **R3** **Case 5**
Module 5: Positive Organisational Behaviour			
13& 14	5	**Positive Emotions and Psychological Capital** Examines the role of positive emotions in enhancing employee well-being and explores psychological capital through the dimensions of hope, efficacy, resilience, and optimism	Chapter 7 **Case 6**
Module 6: Managing Conflict & Negotiation			
15	6	**Conventional and Contemporary Forms of Conflict** Examines the nature, causes, and consequences of conventional and contemporary organisational conflicts, including interpersonal, intergroup, work–life, and technology-related conflicts in the workplace.	Chapter 10 (10.1,10.2,10.3) **Case 4**
16	6	**Negotiation and Conflict Resolution** Conflict-management styles, alternative dispute resolution, and negotiation processes, with emphasis on emotional and ethical considerations in achieving constructive organisational outcomes.	Chapter 10 (10.4,10.5,10.6)
Module 7: Decision-Making and Creativity			
17	7	**Rationale of Decision-Making** Rational and non-rational decision-making, cognitive biases, evidence-based decision-making, decision-making styles and group decision-making.	Chapter 11
18	7	**Organisational Creativity** Group problem-solving techniques, consensus building, practical approaches to fostering creativity and enhancing creative decision-making in organisations.	Chapter 11 (11.7)

Module 8: Power and Politics in Organisation			
19	8	**Power and Empowerment** What Kind of power do employees prefer? Forms of power, power sharing and empowerment, influence tactics, and persuasion in organisational and virtual team contexts**.**	Chapter 12 (12.1,12.2,12.3) **Case 3**
20	8	**Politics & Impression Management** Impression management, and the ethical considerations involved in shaping perceptions and influencing organisational outcomes.	Chapter 12 (12.5)
Module 9: Leadership Effectiveness			
21&22	9	**Theoretical Foundations of Leadership** The distinction between leadership and management, and the application of trait, behavioural, and contingency theories to leadership effectiveness.	Chapter 13 **R5,R6** **Case :1**
Module 10: Organizational Culture, Socialisation and Mentoring			
23	10	**Organisational Culture and Culture Change** *What are the types of organisational cultures?* Foundations, functions, and types of organisational culture, and the processes through which it is developed, embedded, and transformed.	Chapter 14 **R4** **Case 2**
24	10	**Socialisation and Mentoring** The role of socialisation and mentoring in embedding organisational culture, facilitating employee development, and strengthening human and social capital.	Chapter 14
Module 11: Organisational Design, Effectiveness and Innovation			
25 &26	11	**Organisational Foundations and Design** Open-system perspectives, organisational structures, design principles, contingency factors, and internal alignment.	Chapter 15 **R7**
27 &28	11	**Organisational Innovation and Effectiveness** Innovation systems, design thinking, workplace design, and the assessment of organisational effectiveness through balanced scorecards and strategy mapping.	Chapter 15 **R8**
Wrap Up			
29 & 30		**Final Project Presentations**	

Additional Instructions (If any)

- All students are expected and required to come prepared to each class with the assigned readings as well as case(s). In certain instances, but not all or even none, some questions that help in preparations, particularly of the cases may be given by the Instructor in advance to the students, either directly in the classes and/or through the LMS Course page. Case preparations at home will include both self-preparation as well as discussion in one's *Study/Learning Groups*. More on this in the Class!
- **Group formation:**

  Some of the academic works associated with the course, including the Project, will have to be done in groups. Specifics will be announced in the class. Students are expected to value Group work and correctly quote their Group Number when required.
- Any other additional/ relevant sources will be shared on the Virtual Classroom page of the Course.